Know your visa type

Most Canadian citizens and many citizens from Visa Waiver Program countries can come to the U.S. without a visa if they meet certain requirements, which you can read about here.

Common nonimmigrant visas

There are various types of nonimmigrant visas for temporary visitors to travel to the U.S. if you are not a U.S. citizen or U.S. lawful permanent resident. The purpose of your intended travel and other facts will determine what type of visa is required under U.S. immigration law. It's important to have information about the type of nonimmigrant visa you will need for travel in order to understand the steps required to apply for the visa at a U.S. Embassy or Consulate.

Business/Tourist visa

Visa Type: B

Fee: $185 USD

Visitor visas are nonimmigrant visas for persons who want to enter the United States temporarily for business (visa category B-1), for tourism (visa category B-2), or for a combination of both purposes (B-1/B-2).

Learn more about business/tourist visas

Work visa

Visa Type: H, L, O, P, Q

Fee: $205 USD

Temporary worker visas are for persons who want to enter the United States for

employment lasting a fixed period of time, and are not considered permanent or indefinite. Each of these visas requires the prospective employer to first file a petition with U.S. Citizenship and Immigration Services (USCIS). An approved petition is required to apply for a work visa.

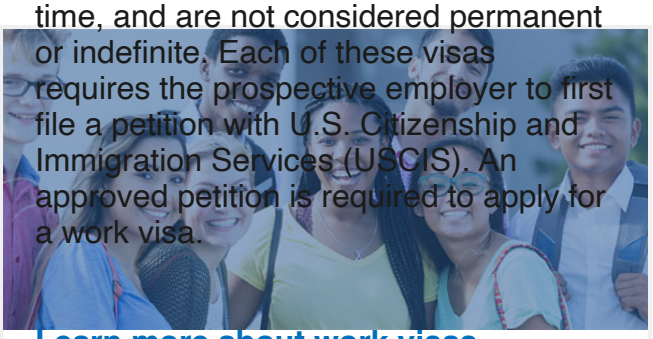
Student visa

Visa Type: F, M

Fee: $185 USD

You must have a student visa to study in the United States. Your course of study and the type of school you plan to attend determine whether you need an F visa or an M visa.

Learn more about student visas



Learn more about work visas

Exchange visitor visa

Visa Type: J

Fee: $185 USD

Exchange visitor (J) visas are nonimmigrant visas for individuals approved to participate in exchange visitor programs in the United States.

Learn more about exchange visitor visas

Transit/crewmember visas

Visa Type: C, D

Fee: $185 USD

Transit (C) visas are nonimmigrant visas for persons traveling in immediate and continuous transit through the United States en route to another country, with few exceptions. Crewmember (D) visas are nonimmigrant visas for persons working on board commercial sea vessels or international airlines in the United States.

Learn more about transit/crewmember visas

Religious worker visa

Visa Type: R

Fee: $205 USD

Temporary religious worker (R-1) visas are for persons who want to enter the United States to work temporarily in religious capacities.

Learn more about religious worker visas

Domestic employee visa

Visa Type: B-1

Fee: $185 USD

Domestic employee visas are for persons who wish to accompany their employer to the United States to perform domestic duties in the United States for their employer.

Learn more about domestic employee visas ›

Journalist and media

Visa Type: I

Fee: $185 USD

Media (I) visas are for representatives of the foreign media, including members of the press, radio, film, and print industries, traveling temporarily to the United States to work in their profession engaged in informational or educational media activities, essential to the foreign media function.

Learn more about journalist and media visas ›

A list of NIV types

Fee: $185 USD - $315 USD

Generally, a citizen of a foreign country who wishes to enter the United States must first obtain a visa, either a nonimmigrant visa for a temporary stay, or an immigrant visa for permanent residence.

See a list of types of NIV ›

Visa Waiver Program

Important Notice: Indian nationals are not eligible for the Visa Waiver Program.

The Visa Waiver Program (VWP) enables nationals of certain countries to travel to the United States for tourism or business (visitor visa purposes) for stays of 90 days or less without obtaining a visa. Not all countries participate in the VWP, and not all travelers from VWP countries are eligible to use the program. VWP travelers are required to apply for authorization through the Electronic System for Travel Authorization (ESTA), are screened at their port of entry into the United States, and are enrolled in the Department of Homeland Security's Office of Biometric Identity Management.

Read more about the Visa Waiver Program

Renew my visa

Repeat travelers to the United States may, under some circumstances, renew their visas without appearing at the U.S. Embassy/Consulate for an interview. Additionally, some governments allow their citizens to travel with a valid visa in an expired passport, provided the traveler also has a valid passport. If your government allows travel with a valid visa and a combination of an expired and valid passport, then the U.S. government will allow you to travel to the United States with your old passport containing a valid visa and your new, valid passport.

Read more about renew my visa

Diplomatic and government officials

A-1, A-2, C-3, and G-1 through G-4 visas may be issued to diplomats and other government officials for official travel to the United States. Generally, the type of visa required by a diplomat or other government official depends upon their purpose of travel to the United States. There are very specific requirements which must be met by applicants in order to qualify for A, C-3, G or NATO visas under U.S. immigration law.

Learn more about visas for diplomatic and government officials

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Change location

The U.S. Department of State's Bureau of Consular Affairs website and Consular Post websites are the definitive sources of visa information. Should there be discrepancies in content, the Consular Affairs website and Consular Post websites take precedence.

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